2020
CHARACTER INDUSTRY WHITE PAPER

SUMMARY

English / 中文

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SUMMARY

Part 1 Character User Trends

1. Research Design

The subjects of this research are Koreans between the ages of 3 and 59, residing in Korea, and have been exposed to character content in the past year.

By setting 1,160,000 research panels nationwide as its sample framework, the research, which is based on the July 2020 resident registration population statistics data provided by the National Statistical Office. This research carried out by sending an online survey email according to the population component ratio sorted by region, gender, and age.

The research was conducted once a year, and the response standard period was from August 2019 to August 2020 (last 1 year), unless stated otherwise. Data collection was completed through an online survey sent from August 3 to 26, 2020.

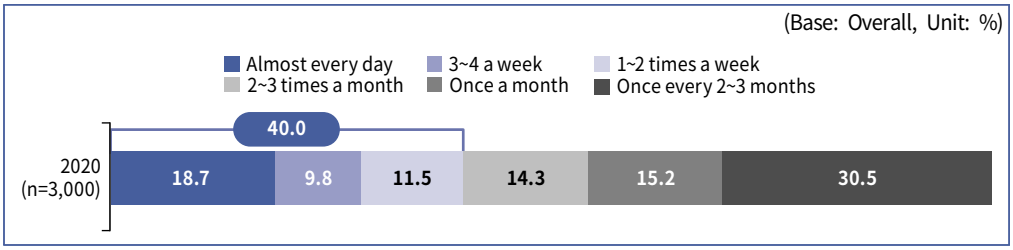
Table 1 2020 Factual Research Design for Character Users

Classification	Content
Target population	All Koreans ages 3-59
Research population	Koreans between the ages of 3 to 59 who were exposed to character content in the past year
Research areas	17 cities and provinces nationwide
Data collection method	Online research through a structural survey
Sample framework	Resident Registration Population Statistics data as of July 2020 provided by the Ministry of the Interior and Safety A total of 1,160,000 research panels set up nationwide by the research institution was used as its sample framework.
Sampling method	Proportional allocation according to region/gender/age
Valid sample	3,000 people
Sampling error	±1.79%p at 95% confidence level
Data collection period	August 3 -26, 2020
Organizing agency	Korea Creative Content Agency
Executing agency	Global Research

2. Character Content Use Frequency in the Past Year

Regarding the character content use frequency in the past year, “Once every 2-3 months” ranked the highest with 30.5%, followed by “Almost every day” (18.7%), “Once a month” (15.2%), and “2-3 times a month” (14.3%). The rate of using character content more than once a week has increased to 40.0%.

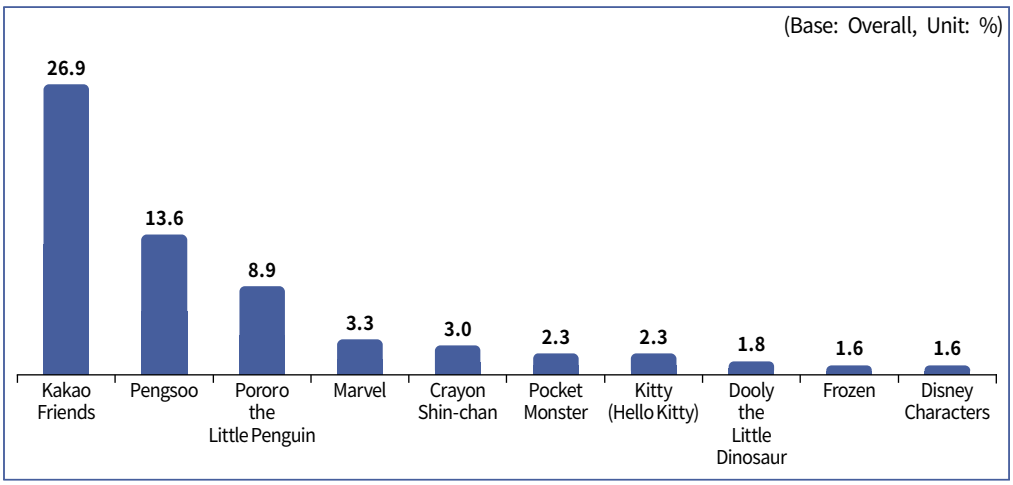
Figure 1 Character Content Use Frequency in the Past Year



3. Most Preferred Character

In terms of character likeability, “Kakao Friends” received the highest result with 26.9%, followed by “Pengsoo” (13.6%), “Pororo the Little Penguin” (8.9%), and “Marvel” (3.3%).

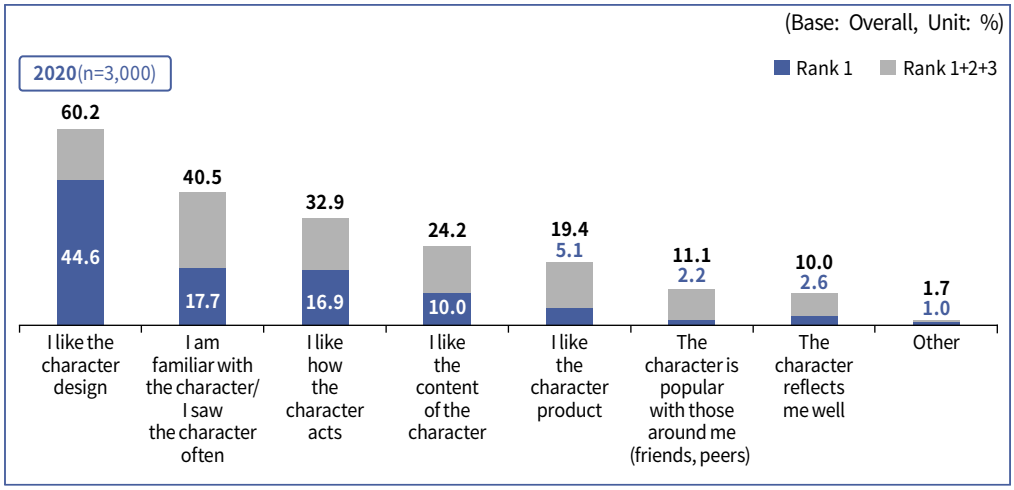
Figure 2 Most Preferred Character



4. Reasons for Character Preference

Regarding the reason for liking the most preferred character (based on the 1+2 ranks), “I like the character design” ranked the highest with 60.2%, followed by “I am familiar with the character / I saw the character often” (40.5%), “I like how the character acts” (32.9%), and “I like the content of the character” (24.2%).

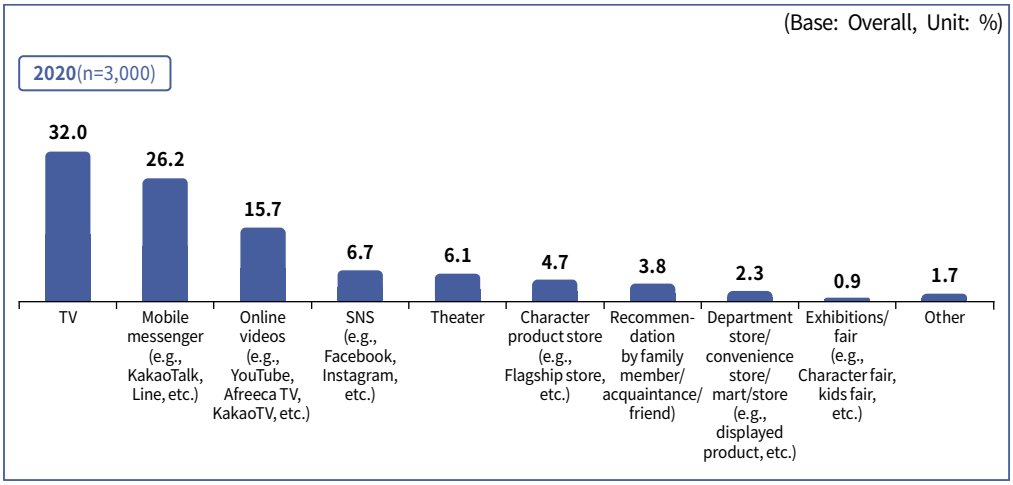
Figure 3 Reasons for Character Preference



5. Channel for Initial Awareness of the Character

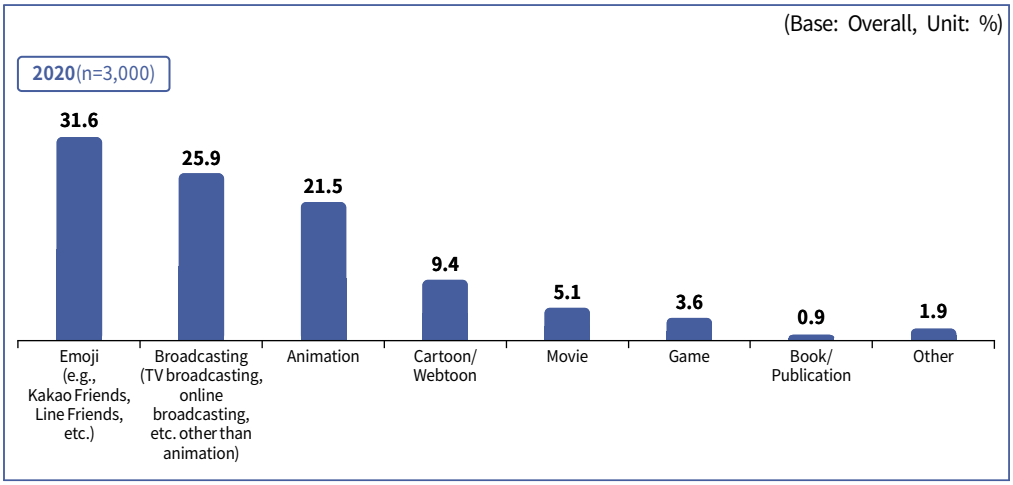
“TV” received the highest response rate with 32.0% for the media channel through which the character first gained awareness, followed by “Mobile Messenger” (26.2%), “Online Videos” (15.7%), and “Social Media” (6.7%). However, if the responses involving online/mobile-based media, such as “Mobile Messenger,”, “Online Videos,” and “Social Media,” were combined, the total sum of online/mobile-based media would account for 48.6%, which was a larger aggregate share than “TV.”

Figure 4 Channel for Initial Awareness of the Character (Media)



"Emoji" (31.6%) and "Broadcasting" (25.9%) received the highest responses in terms of the content channel for initial awareness of the character, followed by "Animation" (21.5%) and "Cartoon/webtoon" (9.4%).

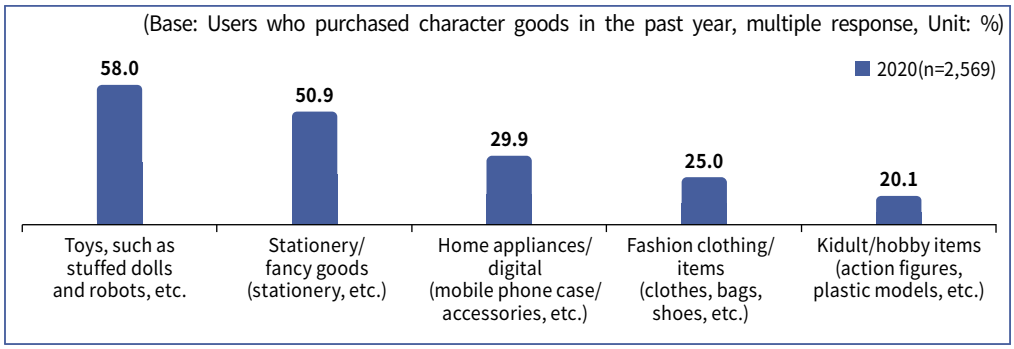
Figure 5 Content Channel through which the Character First Gained Awareness



6. Purchase Trends of Character Goods in a Year

The most purchased line of goods by respondents who purchased character products in the past year was “Toys, such as stuffed dolls, robots, etc.” with the highest share of 58.0%, followed by “Stationery/fancy goods” (50.9%), “Home appliances/digital” (29.9%), and “Fashion clothing/items” (25.0%). The purchase ratio of “Stationery/Fancy” has been decreasing every year, while that of “Toys, such as stuffed dolls and robots, etc.” has been increasing every year.

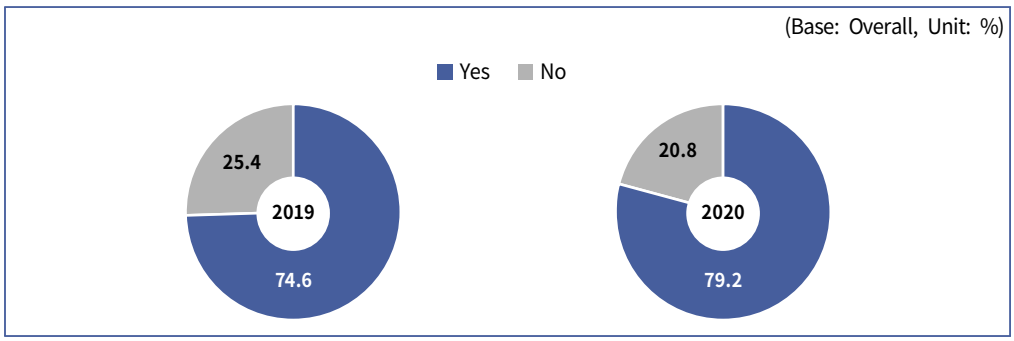
Figure 6 Purchase Trends of Character Goods in a Year



7. User Experience (Purchase) of Mobile Character Products

The rate of experience in using (purchasing) mobile character products was 79.2%, reflecting an ascending trend and increasing by 4.6%p YoY.

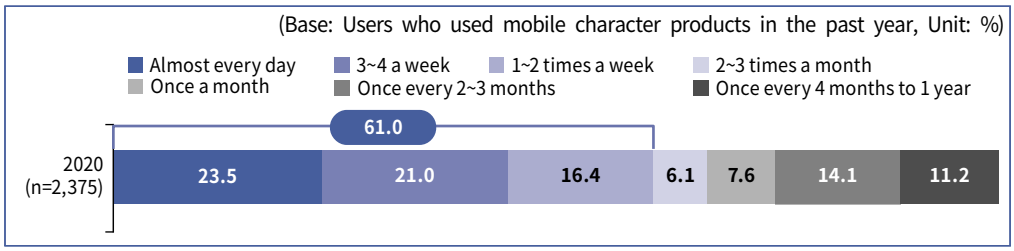
Figure 7 User Experience (Purchase) of Mobile Character Products



8. Mobile Character Products Use(Purchase) Frequency in the Past Year

In terms of mobile character products use frequency, “Almost every day” ranked the highest with 23.5%, followed by “3-4 times a week” (21.0%), “1-2 times a week” (16.4%), and “Once every 2-3 months” (14.1%).

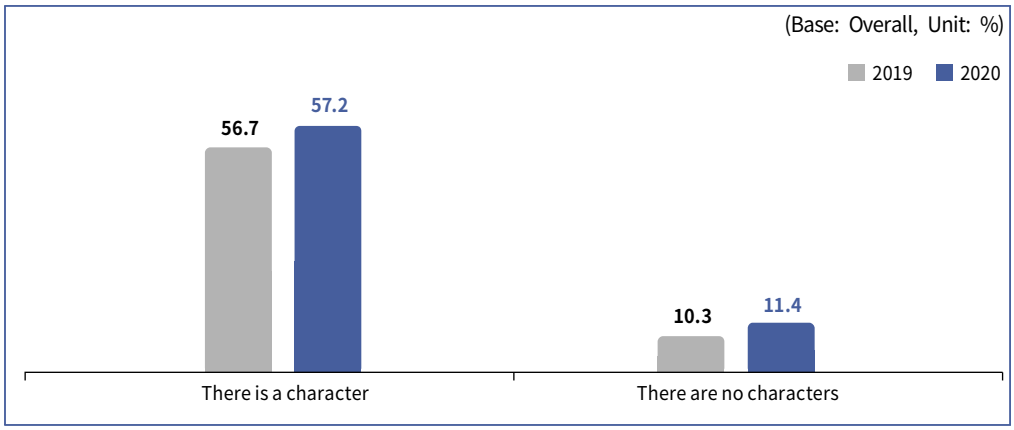
Figure 8 Mobile Character Products Use(Purchase) Frequency in the Past Year



9. Influence of Characters on Purchasing Products

Those who responded that the characters “had an impact” on their decision when purchasing a product turned out to be 57.2%. Compared to the previous year, the “influence of characters on purchasing a product” did not show significant change.

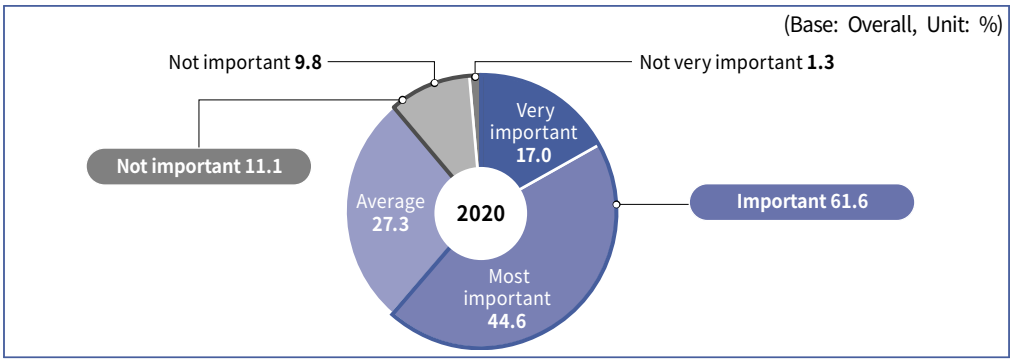
Figure 9 Influence of Characters on Purchasing a Product



10. Influence of a Product's Originality on Purchasing Decision

Those who responded that the originality of a product had an impact on their purchase decision turned out to be 61.6%. On the other hand, 11.1% of the respondents answered it did not impact their purchasing decision.

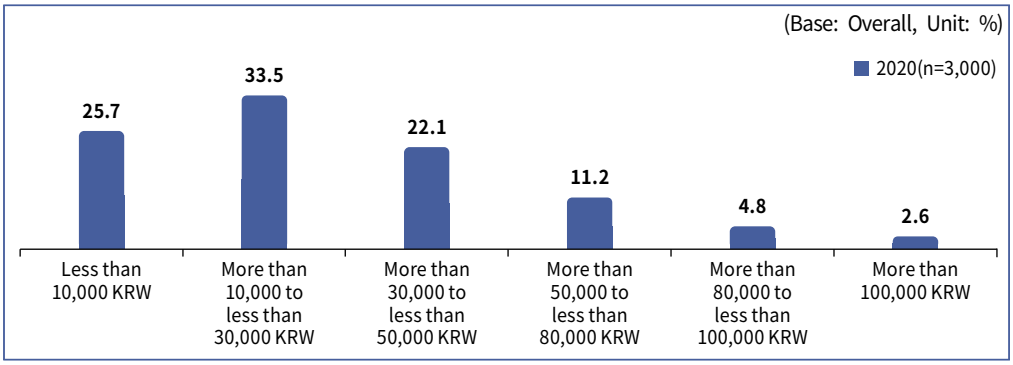
Figure 10 Influence of Product's Originality on Purchasing Decision



11. Character Content Consumption Level

When measuring the monthly average consumption of character content, the response rate of "More than 10,000 to less than 30,000 KRW" ranked the highest at 33.5%, followed by "Less than 10,000 KRW" (25.7%), "More than 30,000 to less than 50,000 KRW" (22.1%), and "More than 50,000 to less than 80,000 KRW (11.2%).

Figure 11 Average Monthly Consumable Amount for Character Content



Part 2 Support Programs for Character

The Korea Creative Content Agency has introduced various production and distribution support projects to strengthen the capabilities of the Korean character industry and revitalize the licensing industry. The following are the key contents of the support projects carried out in 2019.

1. Increasing Production Capabilities

1) Support Program for the Development and Commercialization of New Character IP

The development and commercialization support project for new character IP seeks to strengthen creative competencies and to establish a foundation for the licensing industry to discover character IPs for new content. A total of 17 tasks were selected in 2019, targeting new business owners with less than 7 years of entrepreneurship experience.

Moreover, a new character IP management support project was promoted as a follow-up support for the aforementioned project. A pitching event was held to provide customized consulting and management for selected tasks. It also offered PR/marketing, distribution, and publicity materials, as well as distribution and investment attraction assistance, and strengthened its commercialization capabilities through a boot camp.

2) Support Program for Contents IP Licensing

The support project for content IP licensing aims to revitalize the licensing business through content IP. Production/development and promotion expenses were subsidized to discover and vitalize content IP that was suitable for diversified production, distribution, and consumption environments. In 2019, 23 projects and agreements were signed.

2. Support Programs for Distribution

1) Korea Character Licensing Fair 2019

The “Korea Character Licensing Fair”, which celebrated its 18th anniversary in 2019 is the largest character licensing business market in Korea. It is a character licensing event that encompasses B2B and B2C, including comics, animation, games, broadcasting, MCN, kidult, and art toys beyond characters. It aims to foster Asia's top-notch global character business market, revitalize business for domestic character licensing and support overseas exports.

A total of 2,558 domestic and foreign buyers participated in the event. With 932 domestic and 632 overseas buyer meetings, the amount resulting from the consultations was estimated at 70 million USD. With 130,000 visitors in attendance, the Korea Character Licensing Fair solidified its status as the nation's largest character licensing event.

2) Licensing Conference 2019

The “Licensing Con 2019,” a conference designed to provide business insights for people in the content licensing industry and a forum for networking, was held for the first time. It was held in conjunction with the “Korea Character Licensing Fair 2019” under the theme of "Fandom Power and Universe Building.” A total of 52 domestic and foreign experts were invited to speak at 40 lectures, including the opening conference.

“Content IP Matching Day” was held simultaneously with the conference to promote the secondary commercialization of high-quality content IP. At two events held in Korea and in China, 14 companies presented their pitches for investor matching.

3) Character Contest Support and Character Awards

The character contest support project is aimed at expanding the base of new character creation and extending the path for commercialization by discovering

and rewarding domestic characters. Three tasks were selected through this project, and the contest winners received support to operate follow-up programs, including promotion and marketing, commercialization, and incubation.

The 2019 Korea Contents Awards (Character Category) was established to inspire creative motivation and pride among character industry workers by rewarding best-selling domestic content and hard-working content industry contributors. Five works were selected for the 2019 Korea Contents Awards (Character Category).

Table 2 2019 Korea Contents Awards Winners in the Character Category

Order	Winner	Applicant Company/Person
Presidential Prize	Molang	White Duck
Minister of Culture and Sports Prize	Hello Carbot	Choirock Contents Factor
	The Haunted House	CJ ENM
	Tayo the Little Bus	Iconix
Director of Korea Contents Agency Prize	Sweet Monster	Sweet Monster

4) Promotion Campaign for Character Product Copyright Protection

The promotion campaign for character product copyright protection will support the genuine distribution of domestic character products and prevent the proliferation of illegal distribution that infringes on copyright. It implemented many programs, such as online and offline campaigns, PR, education, and related events, to encourage the public to patronize genuine characters and to foster the understanding of copyright infringement issues.

5) Support Program for Revitalization of Local/Public Characters

The support project for the revitalization of local and public characters is poised to strengthen the local/policy brand, and to generate the activation of local tourism by raising the public awareness of local and public characters and encouraging their use. At the “Korea Local/Public Character Awards 2019”

(Our Character Awards), 13 local and 4 public characters were selected. Moreover, the "2019 Korea Local/Public Character Festival" was held with a variety of attractions, including an award ceremony, celebrated performances, parades, and audience participation events. The 2019 Local/Public Character Follow-up Program attracted 152 representatives of local and public characters and mentees from 19 local governments and public institutions.

2020
卡通形象产业白皮书

摘　要

第一节 卡通形象产业的用户情况

1. 调查设计

本调查的对象为：在韩国居住的3周岁至59周岁的国民中，最近一年使用过卡通形象内容的人。

以调查执行机构拥有的全国固定样本组116万名为抽样框，根据截至2020年7月统计厅居民登记人口统计资料，按各地区、性别、年龄的人口组成比例，按照是否使用卡通形象内容进行了调查。

调查周期为一年一次，调查的内容使用期除非另行提及，否则均为2019年8月~2020年8月(最近一年)。资料的收集在2020年8月3日~26日，通过网上调查的方式进行。

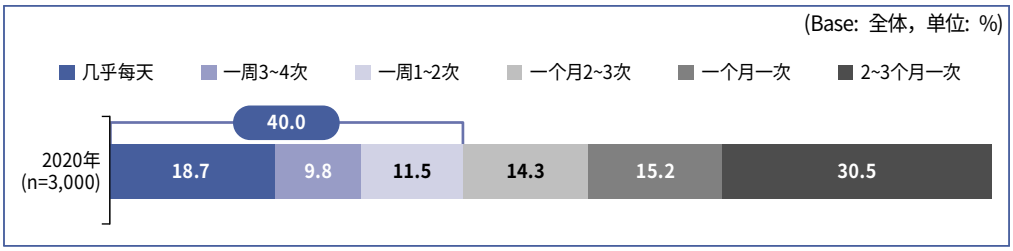
表 1 2020年卡通形象产业用户实情调查设计

项目	内容
目标总体	3周岁~59周岁的全体国民
调查总体	在3周岁～59周岁的全体国民中，最近一年使用过卡通形象内容的人
调查地区	全国17个市和道
资料收集方法	通过结构化的问卷在网上进行调查
抽样框	截至2020年7月，行政自治部提供的居民登记人口统计现状 把调查执行机构持有的全国固定样本组116万名作为抽样框
抽样方法	按各地区/性别/年龄比例分配
有效样本	3,000名
样本误差	在95%置信度下为±1.79%p
资料收集时间	2020年8月3日~26日
调查主管	韩国文化产业振兴院
调查执行	(株) Global Research

2. 最近一年卡通形象内容使用频率

在最近一年使用卡通形象内容的人中，“两三个月一次” 的比例最高，占30.5%。其后，依次为 “几乎每天”(占18.7%)、“一个月一次”(占15.2%)、“一个月2～3次”(占14.3%)等。此外，一周一次以上的比例为40.0%，呈每年增长趋势。

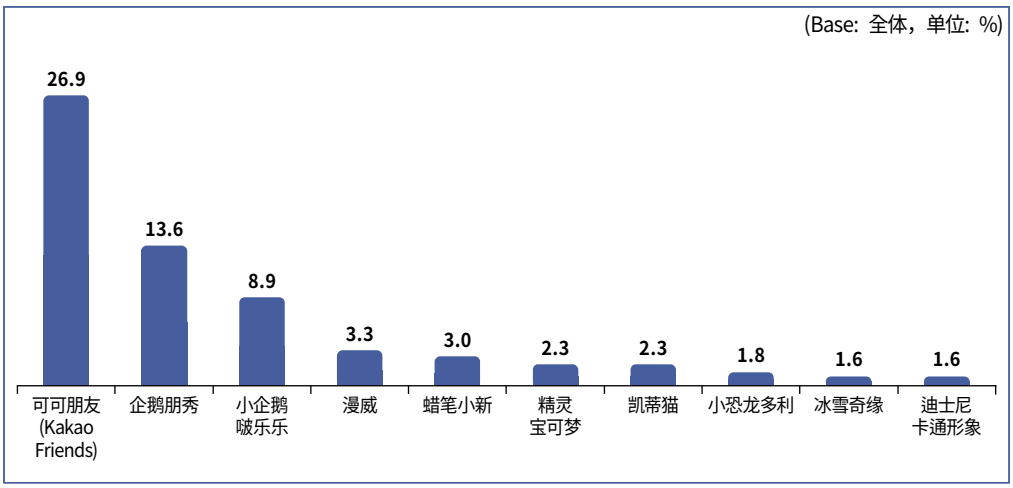
图 1 最近一年卡通形象内容使用频率



3. 卡通形象喜好度前十位

目前，最受喜欢的卡通形象为 “可可朋友(Kakao Friends)(26.9%)”。其后，依次为“企鹅朋秀(13.6%)”，“小企鹅啵乐乐(8.9%)”，“漫威(3.3%)”等。

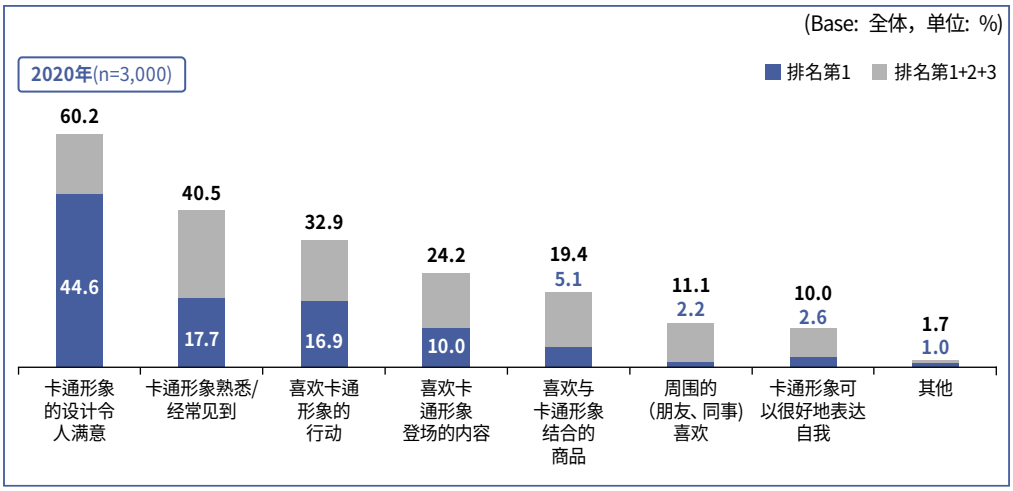
图 2 卡通形象喜好度前十位



4. 卡通形象喜好理由

卡通形象的喜好理由(以第1+2位为准)中，“卡通形象的设计令人满意”以60.2%占据首位。其后，依次为“卡通形象熟悉/经常见到(40.5%)”、“喜欢卡通形象的行动(32.9%)”、“喜欢卡通形象登场的内容(24.2%)”。

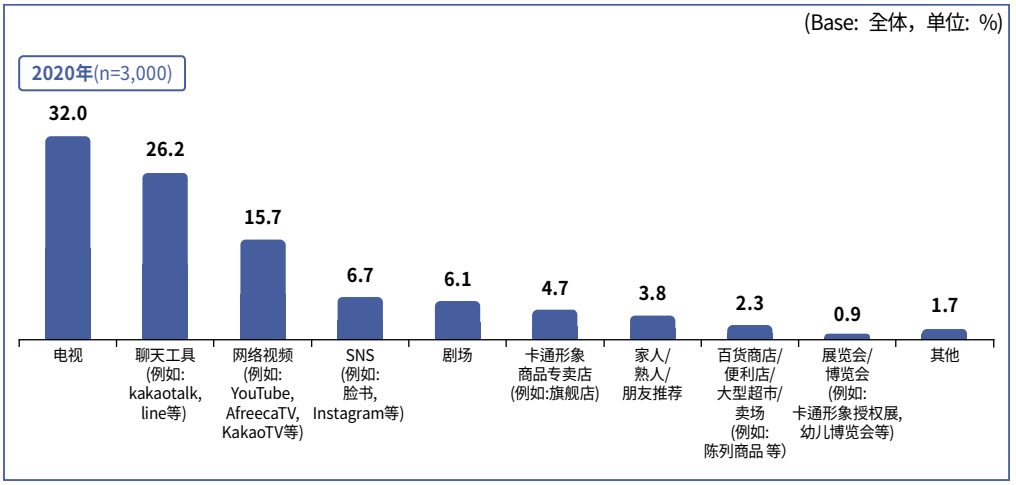
图 3 卡通形象喜好理由



5. 最早认识卡通形象的渠道

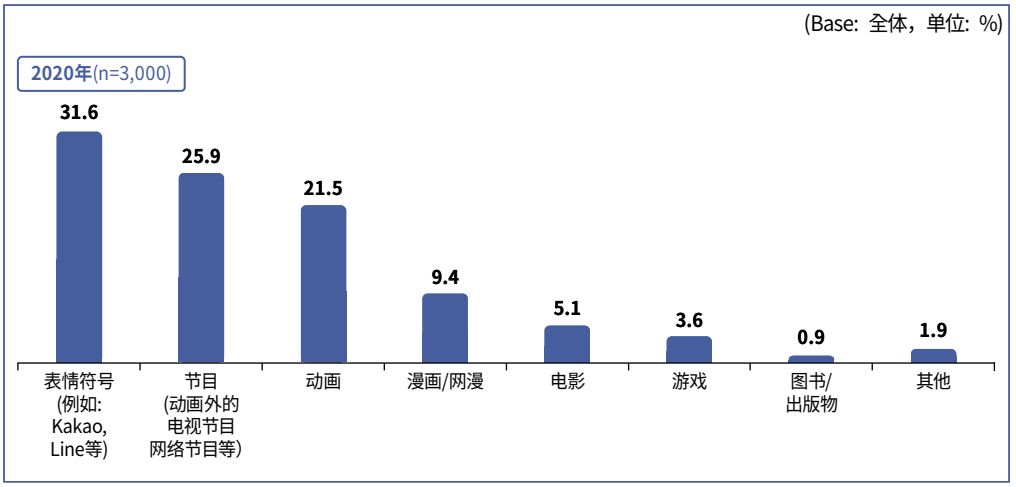
通过媒介最早认识卡通形象的渠道中，“电视”以32.0%占据首位。其后，依次为“聊天工具(26.2%)”，“网络视频(15.7%)”，“SNS(6.7%)”等。虽然最早认识卡通形象的渠道中所占比重最高的为“电视”，但“聊天工具”，“网络视频”，“SNS”等基于网络/移动通信媒介的回答合计为48.6%，所占比重大于电视。

图 4 最早认识卡通形象的渠道(媒介)



通过内容最早认识最喜好卡通形象的渠道中，“表情符号(31.6%)”和“节目(25.9%)”所占比重最大。其后，依次为“动画(21.5%)”，“漫画/网漫(9.4%)”等。

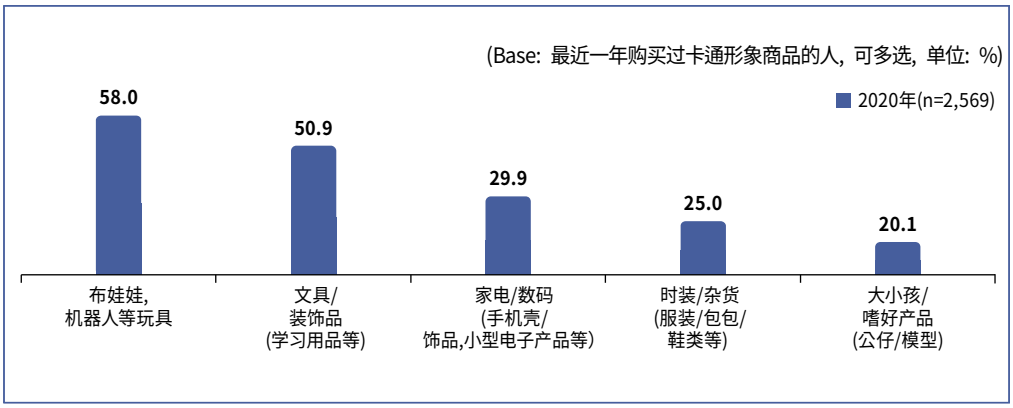
图 5 最早认识最喜好卡通形象的内容渠道



6. 最近一年卡通形象商品购买趋势

最近一年购买过卡通形象商品的人购买最多的商品为“布娃娃、机器人等玩具(58.0%)”。其后，依次为“文具/装饰品(50.9%)”，“家电/数码(29.9%)”，“时装/鞋包配饰(25.0%)”等。“文具/装饰品”每年呈减少趋势，而“布娃娃、机器人等玩具”每年呈增加趋势。

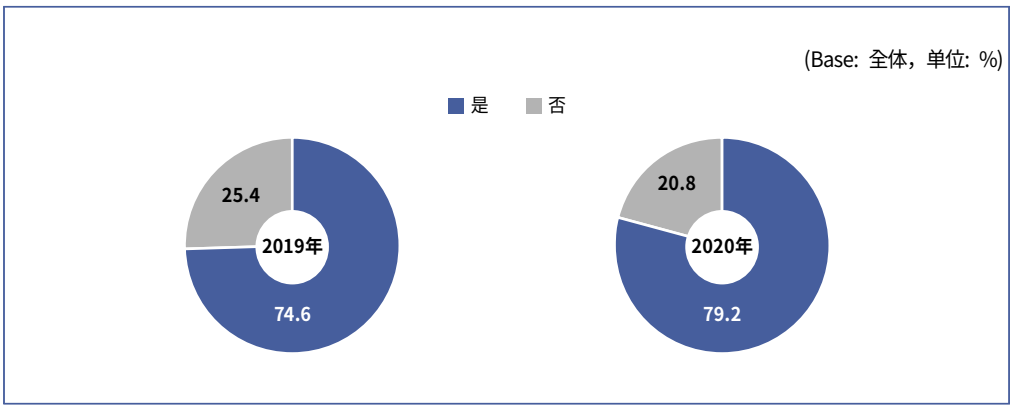
图 6 最近一年卡通形象商品购买趋势



7. 使用（购买）手机卡通形象商品的经历

针对“是否使用（购买）过手机卡通形象商品”的提问，回答“是”的比例为79.2%。手机卡通形象商品使用（购买）比例呈增长趋势，同比增长4.6%p。

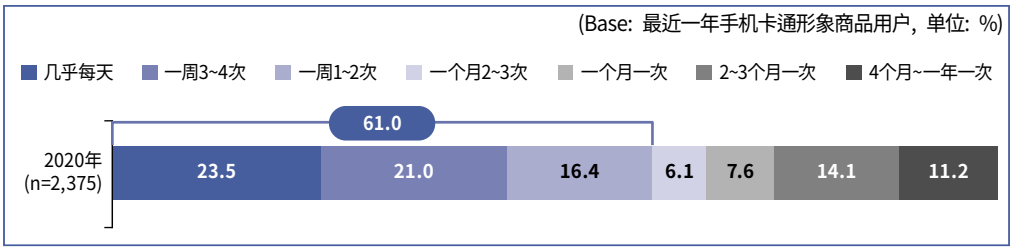
图 7 手机卡通形象商品的使用（购买）经历



8. 最近一年使用（购买）手机卡通形象商品的频率

在最近一年使用（购买）手机卡通形象商品的频率中，“几乎每天”的比例最高，占23.5%。其后，依次为“一周3~4次(21.0%)”，“一周1~2次(16.4%)”，“两三个月一次(14.1%)”等。

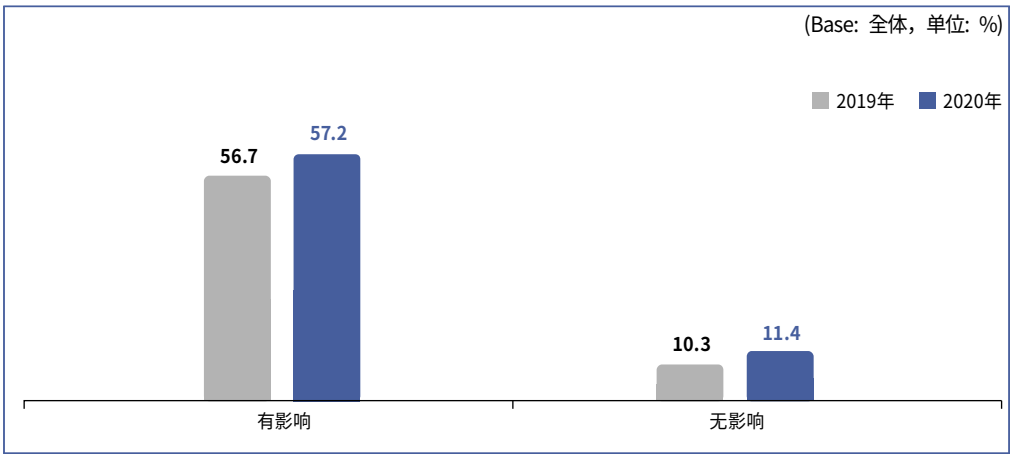
图 8 最近一年使用（购买）手机卡通形象商品的频率



9. 卡通形象是否影响商品购买

针对“购买商品时，卡通形象是否对做出购买决定产生影响”的提问，回答“是”的比例为57.2%，与前一年的调查结果相比没有出现大的变化。

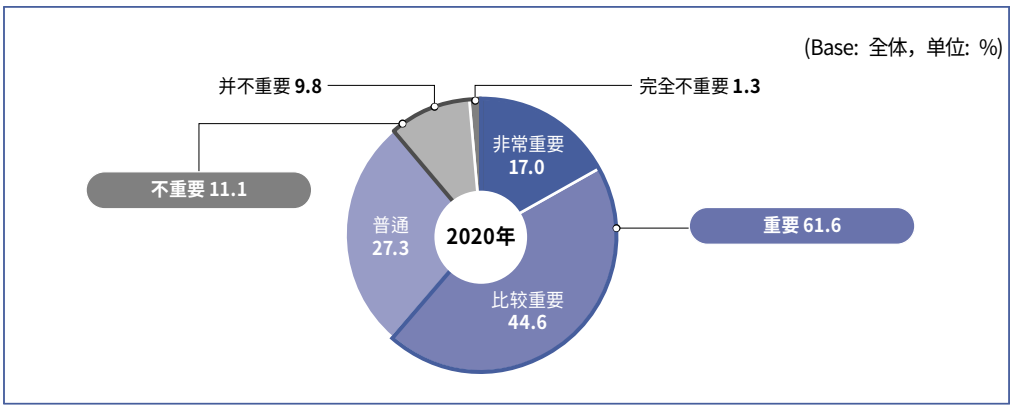
图 9 是否贴卡通形象对购买商品的影响



10. 正品与否对购买商品的影响

回答“购买商品时，正品与否对做出购买决定产生影响”的比例为61.6%。回答对购买决定无影响的比例为 11.1%。

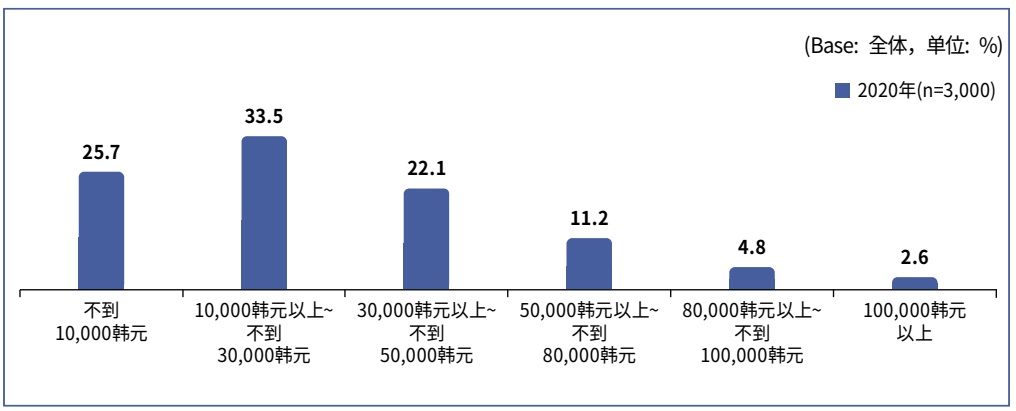
图 10 正品与否对购买商品的影响



11. 卡通形象内容可消费水平

在月平均卡通形象可消费金额中，回答“10,000韩元以上~不到30,000韩元”的比例最高，占33.5%。其后，依次为“不到10,000韩元”(25.7%)，“30,000韩元以上~不到50,000韩元”(22.1%)，“50,000韩元以上~不到80,000韩元”(11.2%)等。

图 11 月平均卡通形象可消费金额



第二节 卡通形象资助项目

韩国文化产业振兴院为了加强韩国卡通形象产业的能力，振兴授权业，推进了各种制作·分发资助项目。2019年进行的资助项目主要内容如下。

1. 加强制作能力

1) 资助新卡通形象IP开发和商业化

新卡通形象IP开发和商业化资助项目旨在通过发现新内容的卡通形象来加强创新能力，为授权产业创造基础。2019年针对创业未满7年的新企业共选择了17项课题。

此外，推进新卡通角色IP管理资助项目作为新卡通形象IP开发和商业化资助课题的后续资助。为选定的课题提供定制咨询和管理并举办了推介活动。该项目还资助了宣传营销、分销和招商引资，并通过举办训练营来加强其商业化能力。

2) 资助内容IP授权

内容IP授权资助项目是一个旨在振兴使用内容IP的授权业务的项目。为了发现和振兴适合多样化制作、分销和消费环境的内容IP，资助了制作/开发和推广费用。2019年签署了23项课题的协议。

2. 分发资助

1) 2019卡通形象授权交易会

在2019年迎来18周年的“卡通形象授权交易会”是韩国最大的卡通形象授权商业市场，是一个涵盖了包括漫画、动画、游戏、电视节目、MCN、杰斗族、艺术玩具等B2B和B2C的卡通形象授权活动。该活动旨在培育亚洲最高水平的全球卡通形象商业市场，振兴韩国卡通形象授权课题，并支持海外出口。

来自国内外的2,558名买家才加了会议，通过韩国932次和海外632次买家会议，洽谈金额达7,000万美元。它还吸引了13万名游客，巩固了其作为韩国最大卡通形象授权活动的地位。

2) 2019授权大会

“2019授权大会"首次举行，旨在向内容授权行业从事者提供商务视角及网络平台。该活动与“2019卡通形象授权交易会”同期举行，主题为 “粉丝力量与宇宙建设（Fandom Power and Universe Building)”。包括开幕式在内，共有52位国内外演讲者应邀作了40场演讲。

除大会外，还同时举办了“内容IP匹配日”，以促进优秀内容IP的二次商业化。通过在韩国和中国举行的两次活动，14家公司获得了投资者配对的推介机会。

3) 卡通形象竞赛资助及卡通形象大奖赛

卡通形象竞赛资助项目旨在通过在韩国发现和奖励卡通形象，扩大创造新卡通形象和进入商业化道路的基础。通过本项目共选出3项课题，入选的卡通形象大赛获奖作品获得了推广、营销、商业化和孵化等后续项目运作的资助。

2019年韩国内容奖（卡通形象类）是一个旨在通过奖励韩国优秀内容和内容产业突出贡献者，激发卡通角色行业从事者的创作力和自豪感的项目。共有5部作品入选2019年韩国内容奖（卡通形象类）。

表 2 2019大韩民国内容大奖卡通形象类获奖作品

奖项	获奖作品	申请单位/个人
总统奖	萌浪兔	白鸭子
文化体育观光部长官奖	冲锋战士	Choirock Contents Factory
	神秘公寓	CJ ENM
	小巴士TAYO	Iconix
韩国文化产业振兴院院长奖	Sweet Monster	Sweet Monster

4) 卡通形象商品版权保护促进活动

卡通形象商品版权保护活动是一项“正品关爱活动”，旨在促进韩国卡通形象商品的正品发行，防止侵犯版权的非法行为。为鼓励公众使用正品卡通形象，传播对侵犯版权问题的认识，开展了线上线下宣传、教育、活动等多种形式的活动。

5) 资助本地和公共卡通形象发展

本地和公共卡通形象发展资助项目旨在通过提高公众对地方和公共卡通形象的认识并鼓励他们使用这些卡通形象，来加强地方/政策品牌，促进当地旅游业发展。在 “2019年韩国地区与公众卡通形象大奖赛”（社区卡通形象大奖赛）中，13个地区和公众卡通形象入选。此外，还举办了 “2019年韩国地区和公众卡通形象节”，提供颁奖仪式、庆典表演、游行和参与活动等各种活动。152名地方和公共卡通形象有关人士参加了2019年地区和公共卡通形象后续资助项目，19名地方和公共机构的学员参加。

2020
CHARACTER INDUSTRY WHITE PAPER

SUMMARY

English / 中文

Ministry of Culture, Sports and Tourism

KOCCA
KOREA CREATIVE CONTENT AGENCY